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THR, 8:00-10:30 AM

English 13

Theme: Nationhood

Topic: The impact of technology in the development of Filipino nationhood among the youth

LOST AND FOUND AND LOST AGAIN!

ABSTRACT

Technology has taken control over humanity. Countries and people are becoming more competitive than ever aiming for progress in all dimensions at the expense of their national identity. For this reason, this paper explicates and scrutinize the impact of technology in the development of nationhood among Filipino youth. It explains how the integration of technology and education could contribute in the implantation of nationhood to the Filipino youth. Hence, it expounds the role of Filipino youth who as digital natives in the development and dispersion of nationhood, nationalism, and patriotism to different generations. Furthermore, it explains the utilization of different media platforms which people can use to promote authentic Filipino culture, honored traditions, and Filipino greatness. Indeed, having a name is as important as having an identity. Our identity may have been lost, but it's not yet too late to find it.

The fast-paced movement of the world affected humanity in all dimensions of living. It created pressure among individuals of different race, religion, and sex. Thus, include the transition on culture which Filipinos are subscribing to. Filipinos coming from different generations embraced and overvalued technology and foreign cultures. As a result, it diluted the sense of nationalism and national identity among Filipinos.

Looking at the current situation of the country, the use of technology is observable everywhere. Every transaction in the government and business are aided by computers. While in the field of architecture and engineering different machineries are utilized to help them better express their ideas. Most importantly, technology provides better platforms for students to experience cultures, traditions, and practices of different nations in the easiest way. Consequently, technology hugely affects the shaping of nationhood through its effect on education and the influence of media.

Presentation and Analysis of Data

Education holds a crucial role in instilling and developing nationhood among its citizens because their view and understanding of their country is taught and nurtured in school. Academic institutions are the most powerful means which form the foundation of nationalism among its people. For this reason, the progress in the educational system of a country hugely impacts the atmosphere and condition of a nation.

The beginning of the country's formal education was when the Americans brought the public school educational system with the structure and elements patterned to their owned system. Consequently, the educational standard implanted to the consciousness of Filipinos was the American style of learning and living. Hence, the educational system brought by the Americans gestated the idea for Filipinos to aim for internationalism before nationalism. Furthermore,

Constantino (1966) argues that education is so powerful that Americans were able to capture the minds of Filipinos. It redirected their view of Americans as saviors and diluted their fervor to resist oppression of colonizers. Unfortunately, the Americans were successful in fulfilling their underlying motives to peacefully and harmlessly influence the country. Their strategy worked out well evidenced by the number of Filipinos migrating to America and Filipinos hoping to travel to America. The “American dream” as they say, Filipinos always dream of experiencing a snowy and cold weather, a dream to watch NBA live, and a dream to see Hollywood stars. The impact of American education has corrupted the minds of Filipinos to look at their country as inferior to America. Moreover, Barrameda (2018) notes that Filipinos were raised and taught as colonizers in their own country. This is because the structure of Philippine education focuses and gives more importance to its vision of producing globally competitive citizens instead of producing competent and patriotic professionals who will work for the development of the country. In this sense, Philippine education should undergo reform where it would develop programs and curriculums which promote Filipino-ness and sense of nationhood among its people. Thus, promoting the Filipino values: “*Maka-Diyos, Makakalikasan, Makatao, at Makabansa*” are not enough in instilling nationalism to students because it must be practiced always.

Furthermore, aside from the contribution of educational system, the advent of technology also influenced the development of Filipino nationhood. Nowadays, schools do not only rely on traditional teaching aids and materials as means to teach students, but is integrated with various technological advancements. The maximization of computers, smartphones, and tablets have made studying easier and more accessible for students. According to Espinosa (2016), the integration of technological products to Philippine education has improved its operations. As a matter of fact, six out of 10 college students agree that tablets improved their studying efficiency. Additionally,

Mayuyo (2018) claims that the number of Filipino children who can read and write in English improved, while the number of schools who used English as their primary medium of instructions exacerbated. It is so nice to know that many people are becoming educated, are able to find work, and speak in English. However, it is also bothering knowing that many Filipino children are well-versed in English and know only few about their native languages. Hence, it's saddening to know that academic institutions choose to use English more often as their language of teaching instead of their students' mother language. In this situation, there is still the Filipino mentality that there is a language superior among all languages. The policy which employs English as medium of instruction in schools weakens the identity of Filipinos as an independent nation. Thus, make them colonizers in their own land.

The integration of technology and education has proven its effectivity to spread nationhood. However, the digital natives who understand complex technologies have big roles to fill in the development of Filipino nationhood. As the famous quote of Dr. Jose Rizal, "the youth is the hope of the motherland", their expertise can be employed to correct the miseducation and mis-identity of Filipinos. The future of Filipino nationhood is laid on the hands of the youth and the succeeding generations.

Millennials are identified as the tech-savvy generation. They can do two or more things at the same time and are skilled and easily taught of the latest innovations of technology (Jiang, 2018). For this reason, Filipino millennials could be a great help in enhancing Filipino nationhood because their savviness can be used in practicing and promoting the authentic culture, honored traditions, and values of Filipinos to the younger generations through different forms of media and the internet. In effect, this will produce citizens who have a good foundation and understanding of their own culture and country. However, this quality could also be a hindrance in the development

of nationhood. Since technology usage is not govern by authority, people can misuse it and abuse it.

Furthermore, in today's time, social media influencers are the best people to utilize to spread nationhood because their internet popularity allow them to reach immense numbers of audience who believe and support their opinions on different matters (Fastenau, n.d). Since most number of social media influencers are teenagers, they can be a messenger of Filipino-ness throughout the nation by the output they create either by blog and vlog posts, tweets, or pictures. In the same way as millennials, their aptitude and skill in social media can be utilize to encourage their avid viewers to practice and patronize Filipino culture. Unfortunately, by observing different video logs, I have seen that social media influencers more likely to promote products of international brands and feature different countries they travel.

Education and people are two substantial factors in developing nationhood. However, what is most crucial are the methods and instruments they use. Mass media is a renowned source of news and entertainment. Broadcast and print media together with social media are the pervasive carriers of information fed to society nowadays. According to the American Press Institute (2017), what media provide is what people subscribe into. Then, this information becomes a shared experience between communities which bind them and later unify them as one nation (Vivian, 2005). In this sense, media have the capacity to change or corrupt the minds of people who subscribe to it. That is why media, in today's time, holds an imperative role in shaping Filipino nationhood.

Filipinos are more familiar with social media platforms because it is what they use every day, everywhere. As a matter of fact, the Philippines is the country across the globe which topped the survey for social media usage and the number of internet users. Filipinos use social networking

sites approximately 4 hours a day (Camus, 2018). Thus, among social networking applications, Facebook got 83.56% of total number of internet users in the Philippines (Global Stats, n.d.). Accordingly, many Filipinos are attracted to it because it is easier, more convenient, and more accessible. But, looking closer, the use of Facebook already alienates them from being a Filipino. The language and content presented are westernized, and if continuously absorbed, would be implanted to their consciousness and practice in the long run. This practice helps in diminishing their Filipino identity because they start to forget their native language. Thus, as this practice becomes a routine, it makes it even more prone to completely forget their genuine culture. While this may be true, Filipinos can use social media in their advantage. Since they use social media frequently, they can post online facts and information about the rich and vibrant history of the Philippines, promote and invite Filipinos to national celebrations which emphasize Filipino greatness and to hold webinars during holidays where they would discuss the significance of that day. There are a lot of things which Filipinos can do to positively contribute in the development and empowerment of Filipino nationhood.

On the other hand, print and broadcast media are powerful transports as well of nationalism and patriotism. According to Vivian (1999) the broadcast media particularly television and radio motivate people to move. Likewise, magazines and newspapers aid people to be updated of the current situation in their community. As a matter of fact, magazines' serialized trait aided Americans to establish the foundation of their national identity (Vivian, 2005). In the case of the Philippines, television and radio are usually present in Filipino homes, while newspaper and magazines are abundant everywhere as source of news and entertainment. The shows and advertisements presented on televisions, radios, and other advertising materials are the means of setting standards for the nation. Based on my observation, most of large companies' commercial

advertisements include English translation in their advertisement. While, most television game shows are patterned to American shows like, Who Wants to be a Millionaire and The Biggest Loser. In addition, during Christmas season various kind of television ads are aired portraying the hallmarks of Filipino values being family-oriented, generous, and helpful. Although it depicts authentic Filipino values, its setting portrays an American culture of experiencing winter which the country does not experience. Consequently, Filipinos misunderstand the idea that western cultures are better than the one they have. Hence, it gives the impression that Filipinos should live like Americans because they are the standard when it comes to being a nation. To contrast this idea, print and broadcast media should depict genuine Filipino culture and traditions. They should give more emphasis or air time to Filipino traditions like fiestas, festive activities, and rituals where Filipino could be reminded of their nationhood.

Furthermore, media content of pop culture is also one of the crucial things which impact Filipinos' concept of nationhood. Media content helps in shaping the mindset of all the Filipinos because what these media platforms feed to them is what they take (American Press Institute, 2017). Unfortunately, today, various Western and Oriental cultures penetrate and continue to influence the minds of young Filipinos. The advent of different neighboring countries culture have become a threat for the survival of Filipino nationhood.

One of the most prominent and pervasive culture since the 20th century is the American culture. From the simplest detail up to the largest, American culture has been part of the Filipino way of living. The clothing, movie themes, series, food, business marketing strategies, and the government are all patterned to it (Balinski, 2018). For the Philippines, America is the best country to compare itself. This is what makes Americans successful in transplanting their culture to Filipinos. The American culture fed to Filipinos by the colonizers through education has been

entangled to the mentality of every Filipino (Anonymous, 2015). Adding to the intensity of its impact is its distribution to different media platforms. Mass media, nowadays present advertisements patterned to American culture. In effect, Filipinos are fascinated and aspire for American products instead of the ones produced here in the country. To address such issue, Filipinos should filter the information provided by various mass media so that they would not be culturally and mentally fed up by American culture.

One of the most pervasive and famous culture which invaded the Filipino consciousness in the 21st century is Korean culture. Nowadays, Korean culture is known to many Filipinos starting from music, clothing, up to telenovelas featured on televisions. It is undeniably omnipresent and spreading rapidly as more and more teenagers subscribe to it.

“Everywhere you go, whether in schools, malls, stores, while riding a jeepney and even to recreational places such as parks and tourist places, you can see the effects of Korean Wave in the Filipino especially to the Filipino youth (Magtortor, 2013).”

Indeed, Korean culture has successfully penetrated the consciousness of Filipinos. Although, it is good to learn and explore new culture, it must be moderated or only to some extent because the tendency of this happening is people forget their identity and embrace that new culture. As I observed, many Filipino youth are imitating the looks and physique of their Korean idols, the country has been an arena for concerts of several Korean artists, and Filipino youth are starting to study Korean language. In this sense, the entrant of Korean culture to the Filipino mentality hinders the reestablishment of a true Filipino identity and nationhood. Furthermore, Dr. Cristina Flores, a Filipino literature professor at the the University of the Philippines-Diliman said in an interview that the reason why Filipinos are fond of Korean drama series is because the stories are simple and

light in atmosphere, it gives a positive mood to the one watching, and it depicts simple stories of fantasies and reality, unlike for Filipinos, the theme and concept of dramas are heavy and focuses on infidelity and poverty (Santamaria, 2012). For this reason, it can be grasped that the fascination of Filipino youth to *koreanovelas* is because it provides an avenue for their aspirations. This could be a great insight for Filipinos to rekindle their interest for Filipino telenovelas.

Conclusion and Recommendation

All in all, technology is a substantial factor for the development of Filipino nationhood. Hence, its integration with education and the pervasive influence of media through its platforms and content are essential things to look at. The utilization of technology to achieve progress is good, however, people should look at it as opportunity to build the nation and nationalism among people, and turn away from the influences of various cultures which often leads to the acceptance of the new culture and negligence of the latter culture. The bottom line is, the missing identity of Filipinos is to be found within Filipino themselves. It is up to them whether they will establish their identity or continue to support the culture of other nations.

Indeed, the Filipino identity was once found, yet lost once again.

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